

incoming message cannot be saved because it exceeds the quota. In `dovecot-trash.conf.ext` you can configure the priority and folder name it should delete. First, the lower priorities are deleted.

The *Expire* plugin helps in running a *cron* job for deleting old emails from the *Trash* and *Junk* folders. You can read more about this at <http://wiki2.dovecot.org/Plugins/Expire>

We'll be using SpamAssassin for filtering spam and, in fact, *Antispam* does have a SpamAssassin backend. But when I was setting up the server, the SpamAssassin mode didn't work properly and it kept causing crashes.

The *spool2dir* backend copies an email to the specified folders when it is marked as spam or ham (not spam) by a user. This enables us to have a learning-filter kind of setup, where SpamAssassin learns from user activity. We'll look at how to set up SpamAssassin to learn about the mails from those directories when we configure SpamAssassin.

The *Quota* plugin backend needs to be configured in *90-quota.conf*:

```
plugin {
  quota = dict:User quota::proxy::quota
}
```

We use the SQL database, so specify the user dictionary.

In order to properly filter incoming spam, we need a Sieve filter that executes before all filters. SpamAssassin marks emails with a special spam header. The Sieve filter will check every incoming mail for the header and, if required, move the mail accordingly to the spam folder.

Sieve configuration titled *90-sieve.conf* is given below:

```
plugin {
  sieve_before = /var/lib/dovecot/sieve/before/
  recipient_delimiter = +
}
```

In *10-auth.conf*, we included *auth-sql.conf*. The *passdb* and *userdb* of Dovecot need to be configured to use our SQL configuration:

```
passdb {
  driver = sql
  args = /etc/dovecot/dovecot-sql.conf.ext
}
```

```
userdb {
  driver = prefetch
}
```

```
userdb {
  driver = sql
  args = /etc/dovecot/dovecot-sql.conf.ext
}
```

That's it! Dovecot configuration is now complete. So let's create a domain and a user in our database. First, we need to encrypt the password of the user before insertion. For this, we'll use Dovecot's *doveadm* utility:

```
doveadm pw -s SHA512-CRYPT
Enter new password:
Retype new password:
{SHA512-CRYPT}$6$ZK6YFoQ/Axi8jlaw$Vbp0n69fBCp6bVE2lNvmrjRmYZr
AA5nb1mgwInR0i1wSe/i.q$swT01qw6ZeEdLY0MLzlgRJFEYmtFyrXSy4/
```

The part after `{SHA512-CRYPT}` in the output is the hash to be inserted in the database.

```
psql mail
mail=# insert into domains (name) values ('accessiblehawk.
com');
mail=# select * from domains;
mail=# insert into users (domain_id, name, password,
quota_kbytes) values (1, 'nilesh', '$6$ZK6YFoQ/Axi8jl
aw$Vbp0n69fBCp6bVE2lNvmrjRmYZrAA5nb1mgwInR0i1wSe/i.
q$swT01qw6ZeEdLY0MLzlgRJFEYmtFyrXSy4/ ', 0);
```

We can now test the server using Telnet:

```
# telnet localhost 143
Trying 127.0.0.1...
Connected to localhost.
Escape character is '^]'.
* OK [CAPABILITY IMAP4rev1 LITERAL+ SASL-IR LOGIN-REFERRALS
ID ENABLE IDLE STARTTLS AUTH-PLAIN AUTH=LOGIN] mail.
accessiblehawk.com Accessible Hawk E-Mail Service
1 LOGIN nilesh@accessiblehawk.com foo
1 OK [CAPABILITY IMAP4rev1 LITERAL+ SASL-IR LOGIN-REFERRALS
ID ENABLE IDLE SORT=DISPLAY THREAD=REFERENCES
THREAD=REFS THREAD=ORDEREDSUBJECT MULTIAPPEND URL-PARTIAL
CATENATE UNSELECT CHILDREN NAMESPACE UIDPLUS LIST-EXTENDED
I18NLEVEL=1 CONDSTORE QRESYNC ESEARCH ESORT SEARCHRES
WITHIN CONTEXT=SEARCH LIST-STATUS SPECIAL-USE BINARY MOVE
SEARCH=FUZZY NOTIFY] Logged in
2 LOGOUT
* BYE Logging out
2 OK Logout completed.
Connection closed by Foreign host.
```

In the next part in this series of articles, we'll look at how to configure Postfix and other parts. By the way, I've deleted my account on the server, so don't attempt a login with the password 'foo';-) 

By: Nilesh Govindraj

The author is a student of engineering in Pune and co-founder of Accessible Hawk, a company dealing with Web hosting, email and virtual machine services. He can be contacted at me@nileshgr.com or [nileshgr](https://twitter.com/nileshgr) on Twitter.